MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • REGULATORY GOVERNANCE (MFS-GOV-02)

Candidate Appeals & Enquiries About Results Policy

Clear two-stage internal review and Awarding Organisation escalation pathway for Functional Skills assessment decisions and Reasonable Adjustment outcomes.

Document Reference	MFS-GOV-02	**Effective Date**	11 November 2026
Quality & Centre Lead	Abdul (Head of Centre)	**Regulatory Alignment**	Ofqual Condition I1 & Centre Recognition Criteria

1. Learner Right to Transparent Review

Every candidate assessed through Master Functional Skills has the right to a fair, objective, and transparent assessment outcome. This policy covers: (a) internally assessed and internally quality-assured components such as Functional Skills English Speaking, Listening and Communicating (SLC) and Entry Level assessments; (b) externally marked onscreen/paper examinations; and (c) decisions regarding Reasonable Adjustments or malpractice findings.

- **No-Penalty Assurance:** Raising a good-faith query helps safeguard quality; note that formal clerical checks or re-marks by an Awarding Organisation can confirm, raise, or occasionally lower a mark, requiring signed candidate consent.
- **Impartiality Requirement:** Every Stage 1 internal review is conducted by an Independent Internal Quality Assurer (IQA) or Quality Lead who had no involvement in the original teaching or assessment decision.

2. Three-Stage Enquiries & Appeals Escalation Pathway

All enquiries and appeals follow structured statutory timescales so learners facing university UCAS deadlines, apprenticeship gateways, or employment start dates receive rapid clarity:

Appeal / Enquiry Stage	Submission Deadline	Reviewing Officer	Written Outcome SLA
Informal Result Triage	Within 3 working days of result notification	Subject Specialist Tutor / Assessment Administrator	2 Working Days
Stage 1: Formal Internal Review (SLC / Entry / Access Decision)	Within 10 working days of result notification	Independent Internal Quality Assurer (IQA) not involved in original assessment	10 Working Days
Stage 2: Head of Centre Panel Review	Within 5 working days of Stage 1 outcome	Head of Centre / Quality Nominee (Abdul)	10 Working Days
Stage 3: Awarding Organisation Enquiry /	Within Awarding Body published deadline	Open Awards / Awarding Organisation Compliance	Per Awarding Body SLA (typically 15–20 Working

Appeal	(typically 15–20 working days of result)	& Appeals Team	Days)

3. Escalation to Awarding Organisation & Regulator

Where a candidate remains dissatisfied after exhausting Master Functional Skills' internal appeals procedure, or wishes to request an official Enquiry About Results (clerical check or marking review) on an externally marked exam:

- **Awarding Organisation Submission:** Master Functional Skills submits formal Enquiries About Results or Stage 3 Appeals directly to Open Awards (or the relevant Awarding Organisation) within the published post-results window.
- **Fee Transparency:** Any Awarding Organisation clerical check or review fee is disclosed upfront in writing, and refunded in full where an upward grade change is confirmed.
- **Regulatory Escalation:** If all centre and Awarding Organisation appeal stages are exhausted and procedural irregularity remains unresolved, candidates are signposted to Ofqual's Complaints Procedure.

Document Control & Annual Governance Sign-Off

Approved By (Head of Centre & Quality Nominee):	Abdul — Master Functional Skills
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Next Mandatory Annual Review Date:	11 November 2027 (or immediately upon Ofqual / Awarding Body update)